The rules on paying for wildfire mitigation changed this year.

Two of the changes are statewide. Neither one needs an application or a waiting list, and most people on this street haven't been told about either.

CHANGE ONE · COLORADO INCOME TAX CREDIT

The state covers the cost of the work, up to a cap

Colorado's wildfire mitigation tax credit reimburses **100% of what you spend** on qualifying vegetation work, up to the cap for that year. There is no application and no waiting list — you claim it on your state income tax return.

TAX YEAR 2026

$1,000

Up to **$1,000** back, at 100% of what the work costs.

TAX YEAR 2027

$2,000

Cap doubles, and the credit becomes **refundable** — you can receive it even if you owe no state tax.

- **Vegetation work qualifies** — thinning, fuel removal and defensible space, to Colorado State Forest Service standards. Available through **tax year 2030**.
- Income limits apply: **$129,200** federal taxable income for 2025 (2026's is set at year end), rising to **$300,000** AGI for 2027.
- **Contractor invoices only** — not your own labour, rented kit, or anything a grant covered.
- Covers vegetation work — **not** structural work like roofing, vents or siding.

Source: Colorado General Assembly 2026 tax expenditure evaluation; Colorado Department of Revenue – tax.colorado.gov/wildfire-tax-benefits. Confirm your own eligibility with your accountant.

CHANGE TWO · INSURANCE DISCLOSURE LAW

Your insurer now has to tell you your risk score — and discount the work you've done

Since **1 July 2026**, this is law rather than courtesy. If your insurer uses a wildfire risk score to price, underwrite, non-renew or surcharge your policy, they must:

- Tell you your property's **wildfire risk score, in writing, every year**
- State **what mitigation discounts are available** to you
- Count the work you have actually done — **defensible space specifically** — in how they score and price the property
- Give you a **discount for documented mitigation**, even if they have no formal mitigation model of their own
- Let you **appeal the score** if you believe it is wrong

If a score notice arrived in your mail this summer, that law is why.

Source: Colorado HB25-1182, effective 1 July 2026 – leg.colorado.gov/bills/hb25-1182. Confirm what your own policy qualifies for with your carrier.

What stops people claiming any of it

The money is real. What people lose it to is documentation nobody told them to keep.

THE TAX CREDIT NEEDS

What you spent, and evidence the work was qualifying vegetation work.

YOUR INSURER NEEDS

Evidence of what was cut, where, and to what spacing — before and after.

Every Sixfold job comes with both, whether or not you ask for them. A written scope of exactly what was cut and where, and photographs from fixed positions before and after. One set of documents, and it serves your tax return and your carrier.

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